

# William Curtis Blanton

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## SUMMARY

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Senior/principal full-stack engineer with 20 years shipping production web applications, five of them as Principal Software Architect. Deep experience making architecture calls inside large, mature codebases with real history — knowing what to extend, what to refactor, and what to leave alone. AI-native: Claude Code is my daily driver, and I build the agent tooling, skills, and test gates that make agent-written code safe to merge. Based in Charleston, SC.

## SKILLS

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**Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), SQL, HTML5, CSS3

**Frontend:** React, Next.js, Astro, TailwindCSS, CSS-in-JS, SASS/LESS, SVG, GSAP, Three.js

**Backend & Data:** Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB

**Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS — S3 data lake, Lambda, EC2, Elastic Beanstalk, ELB, CloudFormation, CloudFront, Route 53, CloudWatch, Cognito, IAM; CI/CD, GitHub Actions

**Payments & E-commerce:** Stripe, Shopify, checkout and order-management systems

**AI Engineering:** Claude Code, agent workflows, MCP tooling, skill and subagent authoring, agent-output review, automated quality gates

**Testing & Quality:** Vitest, Playwright, axe-core accessibility testing, Lighthouse performance budgets, ESLint/Stylelint/Knip, Conventional Commits

## EXPERIENCE

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### Independent Software Consultant — Charleston, SC

Feb 2023 – Present

- Build and operate production e-commerce applications end-to-end for small-business clients — Isla Suds (Shopify), Kalmia Woods (Stripe checkout and payments), and Charleston Bonsai Co — owning architecture, delivery, hosting, and ongoing production support.
- Built an AI-native development practice around Claude Code: authored custom skills, subagents, and MCP-adjacent tooling that turn loose briefs into reviewed, shipped code, with the engineer directing and judging agent output rather than typing it.
- Engineered automated quality gates so agent-written code is safe to merge: unit tests (Vitest), end-to-end and accessibility suites (Playwright + axe-core), staged lint and typecheck hooks (Lefthook), dead-code detection (Knip), and enforced Lighthouse budgets.
- Shipped a high-performance Astro/TypeScript application with GSAP, Three.js, and Lottie motion under enforced Lighthouse budgets (Performance 90+, Accessibility 95+, SEO 95+), WCAG 2.1 AA compliance, and first-class reduced-motion support.

## **Seamless.AI — Principal Software Architect**

Apr 2018 – Feb 2023

- Owned front-end and data-pipeline architecture for a B2B sales-intelligence platform serving 100K+ daily active users, working directly with product and executive leadership to scope what was worth building before committing engineering time.
- Architected the ingestion path from a browser-extension scraper into an AWS S3 data lake ingesting 100GB+ daily, feeding a React web application used for contact and lead data.
- Built and operated the supporting AWS infrastructure — Lambda, EC2, Elastic Beanstalk, ELB, CloudFront, Route 53, Cognito, and IAM, provisioned through CloudFormation and monitored with CloudWatch.
- Mentored 3–5 engineers: set technical direction, reviewed their work, and raised the team's bar on architecture and code quality.
- Made the extend-vs-refactor calls on a maturing codebase, balancing long-term system design against ship-now pressure in a fast-growing startup.

## **Questis — Senior Software Engineer**

Feb 2015 – Apr 2018

- Built and optimized four production fintech applications (HTML5, SVG, CSS3, JavaScript) in a regulated financial-wellness domain, tuning for speed and ease of use across the suite.

## **SPARC — Front-end Developer and Designer**

Feb 2013 – Feb 2015

- Designed and built an in-house employee recognition platform from scratch, including the product's brand identity and foundational style guide — full ownership from loose brief to shipped product.

## **PeopleMatter — Interface Engineer**

Nov 2009 – Feb 2013

- Front-end engineer on the flagship SaaS hiring platform covering the full lifecycle from applicant to onboarding to managed employee, in a large multi-team codebase.

## **Zestra Laboratories — Director, IT Solutions**

Jun 2002 – Jul 2008

- Ran all IT and e-commerce operations: website, order management and fulfillment, and internal systems for a consumer-products company.

## **LANGUAGES**

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English (native) · Spanish (intermediate)